

Jesu, joy of our desiring

Text: Martin Janus, 1665, trans. Robert Bridges, 1927

Music: Johann Schopp, 1642, harm. J. S. Bach, 1716

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The musical score is written for a single voice part on a treble clef staff. The key signature has three flats (B-flat, E-flat, A-flat), and the time signature is 3/4. The melody consists of quarter and eighth notes, with some phrases marked with slurs. The lyrics are printed below the staff, with two verses of text aligned with the notes.

1 Je - su, joy of our de - sir - ing, ho - ly wis - dom, love most bright,
2 Through the way, where hope is guid - ing, hark, what peace - ful mu - sic rings,
drawn by thee, our souls as - pir - ing soar to un - cre - at - ed light.
where the flock, in thee con - fid - ing, drink of joy from death - less springs.
Word of God, our flesh that fash - ioned, with the fire of life im - pas - sioned,
Theirs is beau - ty's fair - est pleas - ure. Theirs is wis - dom's ho - liest treas - ure.
striv - ing still to truth un - known, soar - ing, dy - ing round thy throne.
Thou dost ev - er lead thine own in the love of joys un - known.